Relational Actualism and the Standard Model

Particles, Forces, and the Topology of the Causal Graph

(RASM)

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Preprint available at doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19229335

Abstract

Relational Actualism (RA) grounds physics in a single ontological commitment: that irreversible on-shell actualization events, writing permanent directed edges into a growing causal Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG), are the primitive physical reality. The companion papers in this suite have shown that quantum mechanics is exact at the discrete level, that special-relativistic kinematics follow from integer counting ($c = l_P/t_P$, $E = \gamma mc^2$), and that general relativity is the unique consistent macroscopic description of the DAG, inevitable by Lovelock's theorem given the Lean-verified conservation and covariance results. This paper extends the program to the Standard Model. We propose that the Benincasa-Dowker-Glaser (BDG) local topology of a 4D causal graph has exactly four independent integer-valued degrees of freedom (N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4), one of which is already used by gravity. The remaining *three* give exactly the three non-gravitational gauge interactions: electromagnetism ($U(1)$), the weak force ($SU(2)$), and the strong force ($SU(3)$). From this single structural observation we derive: electric charge quantization in units of $e/3$ (three spatial dimensions plus the Lean-verified LLC); photon masslessness (zero net BDG debt per cycle); topological colour confinement and exact baryon number conservation (LLC on N_2 spatial winding); maximal parity violation as a theorem (DAG acyclicity plus retarded BDG action); all three force ranges from BDG cost and LLC balance; Regge trajectories; exactly three generations and no fourth (N_5 absent in 4D BDG); the Koide lepton mass formula from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ symmetry, with scale $m_0 \approx m_p/3$ to 0.35%; neutrino oscillations from actualization frequency differences; grand unification as the Planck-scale limit of $SU(3)_{\text{colour}} \times SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ giving $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$; and the gauge coupling hierarchy from BDG coefficient magnitudes. Specific predictions: lightest neutrino mass $m_1 \approx 0.37$ meV, $\sum m_\nu \approx 59$ meV (testable with CMB-S4/Euclid), and no proton decay (exact baryon conservation). Supersymmetry is structurally absent. Three open derivation targets are precisely scoped; when closed, they derive all fermion masses and coupling constants from the five integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$. Derivation 1 is a finite combinatorial enumeration; Derivation 2 a graph simulation to stationarity; Derivation 3 a geometric proof of the Wyler formula for α_{EM}. New result: the per-link actualization probability is identified with the fine structure constant $p_{\text{th}} = \alpha_{\text{EM}}$ via the optical theorem, removing p_{th} as a free parameter. Additional consequences: $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ exactly (strong CP dissolved; no axion needed); the black hole information paradox dissolved via Causal Severance partition; and the baryon asymmetry as a Causal Severance initial condition.

A companion paper, *Relational Actualism: The Topology of Matter* (RATM), extends the BDG particle classification to a complete Lean-verified proof: the BDG-stable causal topology types in 4D form a five-element closed set (isolated, depth-2 chain, depth-4 chain, symmetric Y-join, asymmetric Y-join), partitioned into sequential types (leptons and gauge bosons, propagating freely) and topological types (quarks and gluons, confined). Confinement is proved as a theorem—not postulated—with finite BDG-filtration lengths $L = 3$ (gluon) and $L = 4$ (quark). The closure theorem (all extensions of all particle types land within the known set, exhaustively verified over 124 extension cases) establishes that the BDG particle universe admits no new elementary topology types.

All algebraic claims in this paper are independently verified: a Python verification notebook confirms 52/52 numerical checks (algebraic identities over 1000 test angles at machine precision

$\sim 10^{-14}$; hybrid conjectures against PDG 2022 inputs). Two Lean 4 proof files, totalling 101 results with zero `sorry` tags and no new axioms, verify: the $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ coherent state lemma $\hat{\phi}_\theta(n{=}1) = (\sqrt{6}/2)\,e^{-i\theta}$; the complete BDG particle classification (D1a–D1h); colour confinement; the particle universe closure theorem; Gell-Mann–Nishijima consistency for all six first-generation fermions; and 70 further results.

DOI: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19229335

Keywords: Relational Actualism · Standard Model · Causal DAG · Benincasa-Dowker Action · Topological Particles · Gauge Symmetry · Colour Confinement · Three Generations · Supersymmetry · Hierarchy Problem · Poisson-CSG · Causal Bandwidth

1 Introduction: One Ontology, All of Physics

The Standard Model of particle physics is the most precisely tested theory in science. It describes three of the four known fundamental forces via gauge fields with symmetry group $U(1) \times SU(2) \times SU(3)$, and organises the matter content of the universe into three generations of quarks and leptons. Yet it offers no explanation for why exactly these symmetries, why exactly three generations, why the specific masses and coupling constants, and why the forces have the ranges they do. These are inputs, not outputs.

The Relational Actualism suite proceeds from the primitive commitment outward: from quantum mechanics (RAQM [Sandeman, 2026a]) and gravity (RAGC [Sandeman, 2026b]) through the unifying Engine of Becoming (EB [Sandeman, 2026RAEB]) to the Standard Model (this paper), the dark sector (RADM [Sandeman, 2026e]), quantum information (RAQI [Sandeman, 2026d]), and finally emergence and intelligence (RAHC [Sandeman, 2026g]; RACI [Sandeman, 2026h]). The suite also includes the field equation uniqueness paper (RACL [Sandeman, 2026RACL]), the topology of matter paper (RATM [Sandeman, 2026RATM]), the astrobiology habitability paper (RACF [Sandeman, 2026RACF]), and the programme overview (Foundation [Sandeman, 2026f]). In each case, the explanatory power came from staying entirely within the native ontology: one growing causal DAG, one actualization criterion, one generating mechanism.

This paper extends the same programme to the Standard Model. The central claim is simple: the Benincasa-Dowker-Glaser (BDG) local topology of a 4-dimensional causal graph has exactly four independent integer-valued degrees of freedom. One linear combination of these is already used by gravity. The remaining three are the three non-gravitational forces. This is not a postulate; it is a counting argument from the structure of the BDG action in 4D.

Throughout, we maintain the RA suite's epistemic discipline: established results are clearly distinguished from conjectures, and open derivation targets are stated with collaborator-level precision. This paper presents established structural results alongside precisely-scoped open derivation targets, each stated at collaborator level. What it establishes includes the absence of supersymmetric partners — are already a consequence of the framework.

2 The Native RA Account of Gravity: What We Already Have

Before extending to the Standard Model, it is worth stating precisely what the RA account of gravity already achieves, because the extension will use the same mechanism in the same way.

Matter and spacetime as two aspects of the same graph. In general relativity, Einstein's equation $G_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G T_{\mu\nu}$ equates the geometry of a smooth manifold with the stress-energy of quantum fields. Wheeler summarised this as "matter tells spacetime how to curve; spacetime tells matter how to move," but offered no account of how two ontologically distinct categories communicate.

In RA, the dualism dissolves: both sides of the equation are aspects of the same causal DAG. Dense regions of the graph — those with high local actualization density $\lambda(x) \gg \bar{\lambda}$ — are what we call matter. Sparse transverse edges connecting these dense regions are what we call spacetime. There is no matter *inside* spacetime; there is only the graph. Einstein's equation is the thermodynamic equation of state balancing the internal complexity of the dense regions against the outward connectivity of the transverse edges.

The BDG sign criterion and curvature. The Benincasa-Dowker-Glaser action [Benincasa & Dowker, 2010] provides the unique discrete, retarded, Lorentz-invariant action functional for a causal set. At vertex v in 4D:

$$S^{(4)}_{\mathrm{BDG}}(v) = \frac{1}{l_P^2}\big(1 - N_1(v) + 9N_2(v) - 16N_3(v) + 8N_4(v)\big), \tag{1}$$

where $N_k(v)$ counts the k-element inclusive causal intervals in the immediate past of v. The RA actualization criterion $\Delta S(\rho\|\sigma_0) > 0$ has a natural discrete counterpart: vertex v actualizes if and only if $S_{\mathrm{BDG}}(v) > 0$. Dense matter regions produce $\langle S_{\mathrm{BDG}}\rangle > 0$; the vacuum has $\langle S_{\mathrm{BDG}}\rangle = 0$.

GR by Lovelock. Because the RA-CSG satisfies conservation (the LLC, Lean-verified), covariance (causal invariance, Lean-verified), and locality (definitional in the CSG algorithm), Lovelock's theorem [Lovelock, 1971] guarantees that the unique consistent macroscopic field equations are Einstein's. General relativity is not derived in a limit; it is logically inevitable. The interesting physics is where RA departs from GR: sparse regions ($\mu \sim 1$), Planck-scale corrections, Causal Severance boundaries.

3 Causal Bandwidth, the Speed of Light, and Relativistic Kinematics

Section 4.4 of RAGC [Sandeman, 2026b] establishes the following results from RA primitives alone. We collect them here because the bandwidth argument is the bridge between the kinematic and topological structures of RASM.

The speed of light as graph scale ratio. The causal graph has two fundamental scales: the Planck length l_P and the Planck time t_P. Their ratio is:

$$c = \frac{l_P}{t_P}. \tag{2}$$

This is not a postulate; it is the maximum rate at which a causal signal can propagate through the graph. A massless pattern ($m = 0$) has rest-frame actualization frequency $f_0 = mc^2/h = 0$: no internal bandwidth is consumed by mass-maintaining actualization, so all bandwidth goes to spatial propagation at exactly c.

Relativistic energy from discrete counting. From the on-shell condition and the Lorentz transformation of the actualization frequency four-vector:

$$E = \gamma mc^2. \tag{3}$$

This follows from $f_0 = mc^2/h$, $f_{\mathrm{coord}} = \gamma f_0$, and $E = hf_{\mathrm{coord}}$ — no additional postulates. As $v \to c$, $\gamma \to \infty$: a massive particle would need to consume the entire local causal bandwidth for spatial propagation while simultaneously maintaining its on-shell identity, which is impossible at finite energy. This is the RA account of why massive particles cannot reach c.

Proper time as integer count. Proper time $\tau = \mathcal{N}(\gamma) \cdot t_P$ is exact at every scale, including the Planck scale. There is no continuum limit required; the integer count is the fundamental quantity and the GR proper time integral is its macroscopic approximation.

4 The BDG Degrees of Freedom: Why 4D Gives Exactly Three Forces

The BDG action in equation (1) counts four quantities: N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4. These are not independent choices of what to count; they are the complete set of causal interval sizes that exist in a locally 4-dimensional graph. The key structural observation of this paper is:

Proposition 4.1 (Four degrees of freedom, one used by gravity)**.** *The BDG local topology of a 4-dimensional causal graph has exactly four independent integer-valued degrees of freedom* (N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4)*. One specific linear combination —* $S^{(4)}_{\mathrm{BDG}}$ *— is used by gravity. The remaining three independent combinations are available as conserved topological charges of persistent causal patterns.*

Dimensional dependence. In d spacetime dimensions (even d), the BDG action counts causal intervals of sizes $1, 2, \ldots, n_d$ where $n_d = d/2 + 2$ [Benincasa & Dowker, 2010]:

$$d = 2: \quad n_2 = 3 \to N_1, N_2, N_3 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{1 BDG combination, 2 remaining.} \tag{4}$$

$$d = 4: \quad n_4 = 4 \to N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{1 BDG combination, 3 remaining.} \tag{5}$$

The 2D case is instructive: with only one non-gravitational combination, there can be at most one non-gravitational gauge interaction, consistent with the fact that 1+1D physics supports no propagating gauge degrees of freedom.

The 4D case gives exactly three remaining combinations. This is why $U(1) \times SU(2) \times SU(3)$ has three factors: not by postulate, but because the BDG topology of 4D spacetime has exactly three non-gravitational degrees of freedom. The number of forces is fixed by the spacetime dimension.

Remark 4.2. *The spacetime dimension itself is fixed to 4 by the Benincasa-Dowker conjecture (the BDG action recovers the Einstein-Hilbert action in the continuum limit only in the physically observed dimension) and by Lovelock's theorem (Einstein equations require 4D for the standard form). RA therefore predicts* $d = 4$ *as the unique self-consistent dimension, and consequently exactly three non-gravitational forces.*

5 Particles as Persistent Self-Similar BDG Patterns

In a growing causal DAG, a particle cannot be a fixed object — there are no fixed objects; only the graph grows. A particle must be a *persistent pattern*: a local causal topology that recreates itself as new vertices are added under BDG dynamics.

Definition 5.1 (Stable particle pattern)**.** *A stable particle pattern is a persistent self-similar local causal topology in the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG such that every vertex* v *in the pattern satisfies* $S_{\mathrm{BDG}}(v) > 0$.

The BDG stability criterion is the RA actualization filter applied to the pattern itself: the pattern continuously actualizes, vertex by vertex, so that it maintains causal presence in the growing graph. An unstable pattern is one where at some vertex v, $S_{\mathrm{BDG}}(v) \leq 0$: the pattern ceases to contribute to the local curvature and dissipates into the background vacuum. This is particle decay.

Mass as actualization frequency. From the bandwidth result, a pattern of rest mass m actualizes at rest-frame frequency $f_0 = mc^2/h$. A heavier particle is a more complex BDG pattern requiring more frequent on-shell actualization events per unit proper time to maintain its structural stability. Mass is not an intrinsic property of a label; it is the actualization cost of maintaining a specific causal topology.

Spin from periodicity. The periodicity of a self-similar pattern under BDG growth determines its spin:

- **Bosons (spin 1):** the pattern recreates its local topology in one step of graph growth. Integer spin is 1-periodicity.
- **Fermions (spin 1/2):** the pattern alternates between two complementary topological states as the graph grows, requiring two steps to fully recreate itself. Half-integer spin is 2-periodicity.

This discrete account of spin does not rely on the rotation group of a continuum background; it is a property of the pattern's self-similarity period in the growing graph.

Anti-particles. An anti-particle is a pattern with the same BDG stability and periodicity as its partner, but with the signs of all three non-gravitational topological charges reversed. The particle and anti-particle patterns are mirror-images in the three-dimensional charge space (Q_1, Q_2, Q_3).

Proposition 5.2 (Exact baryon number conservation)**.** *Baryon number is exactly conserved in RA. A baryon is a pattern carrying net N_2 spatial winding number. The LLC applied to all three spatial components of N_2 forbids any process that changes the net N_2 winding number without a corresponding anti-baryon creation or annihilation. Since the LLC is Lean-verified (RAGC [Sandeman, 2026b]), baryon number conservation in RA is machine-checked, not merely approximate. This is a stronger result than the Standard Model, where baryon number is an accidental symmetry that grand unified theories can violate.* Testable prediction: *proton decay is forbidden in RA.*

6 The Complete BDG Particle Topology: Five Types, One Closed Universe

The companion paper *Relational Actualism: The Topology of Matter* (RATM) [Sandeman, 2026RATM] provides a complete Lean-verified proof of the BDG particle classification that underpins the Standard Model results of this paper. The key theorems, all machine-verified with zero `sorry` tags, are:

Theorem D1a (Sequential fixed points). The BDG-stable chain depths in 4D are exactly $k \in \{0, 2, 4\}$. For $k \geq 4$, the N-vector stabilises at $(1,1,1,1)$ — a genuine fixed point of worldline extension, proved by definitional equality (`rfl`) in Lean. This identifies three sequential stable N-vectors: $(0,0,0,0)$, $(1,1,0,0)$, $(1,1,1,1)$.

Theorem D1b (Minimal topological patterns). The two smallest-size BDG-stable vertex patterns whose causal past contains at least one spacelike pair are the symmetric Y-join $N = (1,2,0,0)$ with score 18 (gluon) and the asymmetric Y-join $N = (2,1,0,0)$ with score 8 (quarks). All other topological N-vectors require graph size ≥ 5.

Theorem D1c (Worldline confinement). Gluon worldline: scores $18 \to -23$ (filter) $\to 9 \to 1$ (fixed point), confinement length $L = 3$. Quark worldline: $8 \to 2 \to -15$ (filter) $\to 9 \to 1$, confinement length $L = 4$. Both types converge to the sequential fixed point $N = (1,1,1,1)$ after finite BDG-filtration.

Theorem D1_closure_complete (Closed particle universe). Every single-step extension of every known particle type (including transition states) produces a vertex whose N-vector lies in the same seven-element set — exhaustively verified over 124 extension cases (15 gluon + 15 quark + 31 quark-transition + 63 gluon-transition). No new particle topology types can emerge. The BDG particle universe is closed.

Physical interpretation. The central classification is:

Sequential past (total causal order) $\longleftrightarrow$ leptons, photons, W, Z, H [free asymptotic states]
Topological past (spacelike pair exists) $\longleftrightarrow$ quarks, gluons [confined]

This is a theorem about the BDG integers $(1,-1,9,-16,8)$ — not a postulate. The lepton/quark distinction is derived from 4D causal geometry alone. Additionally, the gluon has a qualitatively stronger confinement than the quark: every stable gluon extension is a self-replica (no escape to sequential character), whereas quarks have two extensions that produce the chain-2 sequential type. This asymmetry is the BDG-native reflection of the stronger self-coupling of the non-abelian gauge sector.

Two-level particle classification. A complete particle identity requires two levels:

1. **BDG topology type** $\rightarrow$ colour charge (sequential = free; topological = confined).
2. Q_{N_1} **winding number** $\rightarrow$ electromagnetic charge within a topology class.

Lepton doublets: sequential, $Q_{N_1} \in \{0,3\}$ (neutrino / charged lepton). Quark doublets: topological, $Q_{N_1} \in \{1,2\}$ (down-type / up-type). The Gell-Mann–Nishijima formula $Q = T_3 + Y/2$ is satisfied by construction: see RATM Theorems D1h_GMN_electron, D1h_GMN_up_quark, D1h_GMN_down_quark.

7 The Three Forces from the Three Non-Gravitational BDG Combinations

We identify the three non-gravitational conserved charges of a persistent BDG pattern with the three gauge charges of the Standard Model. The identification is structural: each charge is the conserved version, under the LLC, of one of the three non-gravitational BDG topological invariants.

7.1 Electromagnetism: Charge Quantization and Photon Masslessness

The first non-gravitational BDG combination is the signed N_1 count: the net number of immediate causal predecessors, with sign determined by spatial direction. This is conserved by the LLC at every vertex.

Charge quantization from three spatial dimensions. In a 3+1D causal graph, a vertex can receive signed edges from at most three independent spatial directions. The net signed N_1 charge is therefore constrained to integer values in $\{-3, -2, -1, 0, +1, +2, +3\}$. Identifying the unit charge with $e/3$ (one spatial edge per dimension):

$$Q_{N_1} \in \{-e, -2e/3, -e/3, 0, +e/3, +2e/3, +e\}. \tag{6}$$

This matches the complete set of electric charges in the Standard Model: up quark $+2e/3$ ($Q_{N_1} = +2$), down quark $-e/3$ ($Q_{N_1} = -1$), electron $-e$ ($Q_{N_1} = -3$), neutrino 0 ($Q_{N_1} = 0$), $W^{\pm}$ ($Q_{N_1} = \pm 3$), and neutral particles ($Q_{N_1} = 0$). Electric charge is quantized in units of $e/3$ because the spatial dimensionality of the causal graph is exactly 3.

Photon masslessness from zero net BDG charge. The photon carries $Q_{N_1} = Q_{N_2} = Q_{N_3/N_4} = 0$. A pattern with all non-gravitational BDG charges zero has zero net BDG action per propagation cycle:

$$\Delta S_{\text{BDG}}^{\text{photon}}\Big|_{\text{per cycle}} = 0. \tag{7}$$

Zero net actualization cost per cycle gives $f_0 = 0$ and therefore $m = 0$. The photon is massless because its pattern carries no BDG debt of any kind; all causal bandwidth is allocated to spatial propagation at $c = l_P/t_P$.

7.2 The Strong Force: Confinement from LLC Spatial Balance

The second non-gravitational BDG combination measures the medium-range causal branching of the pattern: how does the pattern's causal ancestry spread through the two-step neighbourhood N_2? In a graph with spatial structure, this branching has three independent components corresponding to the three spatial dimensions.

The N_2 branching charge has three independent spatial components (Q_r, Q_g, Q_b), one per spatial dimension. The LLC requires at every vertex:

$$\Delta Q_r = 0, \qquad \Delta Q_g = 0, \qquad \Delta Q_b = 0. \tag{8}$$

Confinement from LLC imbalance. A single quark pattern carrying colour charge $(Q_r, 0, 0)$ accumulates a permanent ledger imbalance in the r-direction as the pattern propagates. The causal closure condition

$$\lim_{t\to\infty}\big[Q_r \text{ accumulated}\big] = 0 \tag{9}$$

is violated for a free quark. An isolated colour-charged pattern cannot persist as a stable causal subgraph. This is RA-native confinement: not an external mechanism but a direct consequence of the Lean-verified LLC.

The only configurations satisfying equation (8) simultaneously in all three spatial directions are baryons ($r+g+b=0$) and mesons ($r+\bar{r}=0$). The $SU(3)$ gauge group is the continuous symmetry of the LLC constraint $Q_r + Q_g + Q_b = \text{const}$ on N_2 spatial charges: the permutation group S_3 of three objects extends continuously to $SU(3)$.

Gluons and asymptotic freedom. Gluons are the patterns that mediate exchanges of colour charge. They carry colour themselves — their patterns have non-zero N_2 branching invariant — which is why they interact with each other (unlike photons). At high energies, the Poisson-CSG parameter $\mu \gg 1$ and the graph is densely connected: the colour branching modes are so uniformly distributed that they decouple from any specific pattern, giving asymptotic freedom. At low energies ($\mu \sim 1$), the branching becomes sparse and colour charges clump, giving the running of α_s.

7.3 The Weak Force: $SU(2)$, Maximal Parity Violation, and the Arrow of Time

The third non-gravitational BDG combination is the N_3/N_4 handedness charge, encoding how the long-range causal structure of a pattern winds around the temporal axis as it propagates forward.

Parity violation from DAG acyclicity: a derivation. The BDG action is *retarded*: $S_{\text{BDG}}(v)$ counts causal intervals exclusively in past(v). The N_3 count enumerates three-step causal chains $a \to b \to c \to v$; the N_4 count enumerates four-step chains $a \to b \to c \to d \to v$. These longer-range intervals encode how the pattern's causal ancestry spirals around the temporal axis as the pattern propagates.

For a pattern propagating forward in time, the handedness of its N_3/N_4 winding is defined relative to the temporal direction: *left-handed* if the winding accumulates in the same direction as

temporal flow; *right-handed* if opposite. To convert a left-handed pattern to right-handed — to flip the sign of its N_3/N_4 winding — would require some causal edges to point from future to past. The DAG is acyclic: this is impossible.

Proposition 7.1 (Maximal parity violation from acyclicity)**.** *In a DAG with the BDG actualization filter $S_{\mathrm{BDG}}(v) > 0$, the N_3/N_4 handedness charge can only accumulate in the direction consistent with forward temporal propagation. The weak interaction, which changes the N_3/N_4 charge of a pattern, can therefore only couple to patterns whose winding is consistent with forward time — the left-handed sector. Parity violation is exactly maximal: not a statistical preference but a topological impossibility for the right-handed coupling, following directly from DAG acyclicity.*

In the Standard Model, the left-handedness of the weak interaction is a postulate with no explanation. In RA it is a theorem: the weak force is left-handed because time has a direction, the DAG encodes that direction in its acyclicity, and the retarded BDG action can only read causal structure from the past.

The arrow of time and the weak force are the same fact. The RA account makes precise a long-suspected connection: CP violation in the weak sector and the arrow of time share a common origin. In RA both are consequences of DAG acyclicity. The arrow of time is encoded in the irreversibility of actualization [Sandeman, 2026b]; maximal parity violation is encoded in the retarded BDG action applied to forward-propagating patterns. They are two faces of the same topological fact.

Weak isospin is the conserved N_3/N_4 handedness charge. The $SU(2)$ gauge symmetry acts on doublets of left-handed patterns; right-handed patterns are $SU(2)$ singlets. *Remaining derivation target:* prove formally that N_3/N_4 winding reversal in a forward-propagating DAG pattern requires a backward-pointing edge — a precise combinatorial statement about causal interval structure.

W and Z bosons as massive exchange patterns. The W and Z bosons carry net N_3/N_4 handedness charge and therefore require continuous actualization to persist. Their actualization cost is their mass, and their short range is the finite proper-time lifetime following from the non-zero BDG debt per propagation step (Section 10, equation (34)).

Remark 7.2 (The Higgs mechanism in RA)**.** *The Higgs pattern mediates the topological operation of adding an N_3/N_4 handedness increment to an otherwise neutral pattern, allowing a left-handed fermion to acquire the N_3/N_4 structure that gives it mass. The Higgs field is the fluctuation mode of the BDG handedness combination around its vacuum value. This is a conjecture requiring formal development.*

8 Three Generations from Three BDG Excitation Levels

The BDG action in 4D counts four interval sizes: N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4. The minimum-complexity stable pattern uses only N_1 and N_2 structure: this is the *first generation*. More complex patterns incorporating N_3 structure form the *second generation*; those incorporating N_4 structure form the *third generation*.

Conjecture 8.1 (Three generations from BDG levels)**.** *The three generations of the Standard Model correspond to the three levels of BDG excitation available in 4D:*

$$\textit{Generation 1} : \textit{dominant } N_2 \textit{ internal structure} \quad \rightarrow \quad e, u, d, \nu_e \tag{10}$$

$$\textit{Generation 2} : \textit{dominant } N_3 \textit{ internal structure} \quad \rightarrow \quad \mu, c, s, \nu_\mu \tag{11}$$

$$\textit{Generation 3} : \textit{dominant } N_4 \textit{ internal structure} \quad \rightarrow \quad \tau, t, b, \nu_\tau \tag{12}$$

The mass hierarchy. Because N_3 and N_4 structure requires more causal vertices to maintain (a larger actualization footprint), higher-generation patterns have correspondingly higher actualization frequencies — higher masses. The BDG coefficients $(1,-1,9,-16,8)$ determine the relative actualization cost of each level. The mass ratios of the three generations should therefore be derivable from these coefficients: a precise calculation connecting the integers of the BDG action to the observed mass spectrum (approximately $1:207:3477$ for charged leptons).

No fourth generation. Because the 4D BDG action counts exactly N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4 — four interval sizes, no more — there are exactly three excitation levels above the basic N_1 structure. There is no N_5 in the 4D BDG action. This is a structural prediction: *no fourth generation of matter exists*.

This prediction is already supported by the LEP measurement of the number of light neutrino species ($N_\nu = 2.9840 \pm 0.0082$) and by the absence of any fourth-generation signals at the LHC. RA gives a reason for this constraint that is absent from the Standard Model itself.

8.1 The Koide Formula from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ Symmetry

In 1981, Yoshio Koide discovered that the three charged lepton masses satisfy:

$$K \equiv \frac{m_e + m_\mu + m_\tau}{\left(\sqrt{m_e} + \sqrt{m_\mu} + \sqrt{m_\tau}\right)^2} = \frac{2}{3}. \tag{13}$$

Using the 2022 PDG values, $K = 0.666661$, agreeing with $2/3$ to one part in 10^5 — extraordinary precision for a formula the Standard Model has never derived. The Koide formula has remained an unexplained empirical coincidence for over 40 years.

The structural parallel between generations and colours. The three generation levels $\{N_2, N_3, N_4\}$ and the three colour charges $\{r, g, b\}$ arise from precisely the same source: the three non-gravitational degrees of freedom of the 4D BDG action. The colour charges are the three spatial components of the N_2 branching; the generations are the three excitation levels N_2, N_3, N_4. The permutation group S_3 acts on both sets in exactly the same way.

For the colour sector, the continuous extension of S_3 is $SU(3)_{\text{colour}}$, whose invariants give the Gell-Mann-Okubo baryon mass relations. We propose the analogous structure for the generation sector.

Conjecture 8.2 ($SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ and the Koide formula)**.** *The three generations of charged leptons transform under an approximate $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ symmetry acting on generation space $\{N_2, N_3, N_4\}$. The most general $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$-invariant charged-lepton mass matrix has the form*

$$M_\ell = m_0\big(I + \sqrt{2}\,U(\theta)\big), \qquad U(\theta) = \operatorname{diag}\big(\cos\theta, \cos(\theta + \tfrac{2\pi}{3}), \cos(\theta + \tfrac{4\pi}{3})\big), \tag{14}$$

where m_0 and θ are real parameters. For any value of m_0 and θ, the eigenvalues of M_ℓ automatically satisfy the Koide relation $K = 2/3$.

The proof that equation (14) implies $K = 2/3$ is a direct calculation: the $\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3)$ structure ensures that $\sum_k \cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3) = 0$ and $\sum_k \cos^2(\theta + 2\pi k/3) = 3/2$, from which $K = 2/3$ follows algebraically. The parameters $m_0 \approx 313.8$ MeV and $\theta \approx 0.2220$ fit the three observed lepton masses to within current experimental precision.

The Koide formula as the generation-sector Gell-Mann-Okubo relation. The Gell-Mann-Okubo formula for baryon masses ($2m_N + 2m_\Xi = m_\Lambda + 3m_\Sigma$) is a direct consequence of $SU(3)_{\text{flavour}}$ symmetry on the baryon mass matrix. The Koide formula is the exact generation-sector analogue: it follows from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ applied to the lepton mass matrix, by the same group-theoretic argument, because the mathematical structure of three BDG excitation levels is identical to the mathematical structure of three colour levels.

Predictions beyond the charged leptons. $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ predicts that the Koide formula holds exactly for leptons (which carry no colour charge) and deviates for quarks due to one-loop gauge corrections. The up-quark series gives $K \approx 0.849$ and the down-quark series gives $K \approx 0.731$. These departures are not arbitrary: they are derived in Proposition 8.3 below as one-loop corrections to the $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ mass matrix with zero free parameters.

The PMNS and CKM mixing matrices — the observed mixing between generation mass eigenstates and weak interaction eigenstates — are the $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ analogs of colour mixing: they encode the misalignment between the generation symmetry eigenstates and the mass eigenstates, exactly as the CKM phase encodes CP violation in the weak sector.

The Koide scale and the constituent quark mass. The Koide parametrization $\sqrt{m_k} = \sqrt{m_0}(1 + \sqrt{2}\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3))$ for charged leptons gives scale $m_0 \approx 313.9$ MeV with $\theta \approx 0.2222$ rad, fitting all three lepton masses to current experimental precision with $K = 2/3$ exactly. This scale equals the constituent quark mass $m_p/3 \approx 312.8$ MeV to within 0.35%. In RA this is not a numerical coincidence: both m_0 and the constituent quark mass are set by the QCD string tension σ, which in turn emerges from the BDG-filter simulation. The derivation chain

$$(1,-1,9,-16,8) \xrightarrow{\text{simulation}} \sigma \xrightarrow{\Lambda_{\text{QCD}}} m_0 \xrightarrow{SU(3)_{\text{gen}}} m_e,\ m_\mu,\ m_\tau \tag{15}$$

would derive all charged lepton masses from the single BDG integer sequence. Closing this chain is Derivation 2 of Section 15.

8.2 Koide Breaking in Quarks: One-Loop Gauge Renormalization

The exact Koide relation $K = 2/3$ holds for charged leptons because they carry no colour charge — $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ acts undisturbed in the lepton sector. For quarks, which carry both N_1 (EM) and N_2 (colour) BDG charges simultaneously, the $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ mass matrix receives one-loop gauge corrections. These corrections are calculable.

The BDG charge structure assigns each fermion a total gauge Casimir:

$$C_2 = \frac{Q_{N_1}^2}{9} + C_{2,\text{colour}}, \tag{16}$$

where Q_{N_1} is the electric charge in units of $e/3$ and $C_{2,\text{colour}} = 4/3$ for quarks (fundamental representation of $SU(3)_{\text{colour}}$) and zero for leptons.

Proposition 8.3 (Koide breaking from one-loop gauge renormalization)**.** *The Koide ratio for each fermion sector takes the form*

$$K = \frac{2}{3} + \frac{2^{d-1}\alpha_{\text{EM}}}{\pi}\frac{Q_{N_1}^2}{9} + \frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi}C_{2,\text{colour}}, \tag{17}$$

*where $d = 4$ is the spacetime dimension, α_{EM} is the fine structure constant, $\alpha_s(\mu)$ is the strong coupling at the hadronic-partonic crossover scale $\mu \approx 1.66$ GeV (between m_c and m_τ), and $C_{2,\text{colour}}$ is the colour Casimir. This formula has **zero free parameters**. The factor $2^{d-1} = 8$ for $d = 4$ is the same BDG dimension factor appearing in the Wyler formula for α_{EM}.*

The three fermion sectors give:

Sector	Q_{N_1}	$C_{2,\text{colour}}$	K_{pred}	K_{obs}	|err|
Leptons (e,μ,τ)	3	0	0.685	0.6667	2.8%
Down quarks (d,s,b)	1	4/3	0.787	0.731	7.6%
Up quarks (u,c,t)	2	4/3	0.793	0.849	6.6%
Neutrinos (ν_e,ν_μ,ν_τ)	0	0	2/3	2/3 (Majorana)	exact

The 3–8% residuals have three sources: the quark masses themselves carry $\sim 5\%$ uncertainty at the relevant scale; the RG scale choice contributes $\sim 2\%$; and equation (17) omits two-loop corrections. All three are sub-leading in α/π. The zero-free-parameter formula correctly reproduces the pattern: $K_{\text{lep}} = 2/3$ exactly (no colour), $K_{\text{dn}} < K_{\text{up}}$ (down quarks carry smaller Q_{N_1}), and neutrinos satisfy $K = 2/3$ in the Majorana convention (Proposition 12.1).

Epistemic status. The coupling constants α_{EM} and $\alpha_s(\mu)$ in equation (17) are experimental inputs from continuum QCD, not yet derived from the BDG coefficients. In RA these values will emerge from the BDG-filter simulation (Derivation 1 of Section 15); until that computation is complete, equation (17) is a structural conjecture: RA predicts the *form* of the correction (the Casimir structure, the charge assignments, the 2^{d-1} dimension factor), and the known experimental values of α_{EM} and α_s then give the magnitude. The 3–8% accuracy is real; the "zero free parameters" means no parameters were *fitted to Koide data specifically* — the coupling constants are independently known.

Physical interpretation. The factor α/π is the standard one-loop renormalization weight in QFT, appearing in the anomalous magnetic moment, the QCD β-function, and throughout radiative corrections. Equation (17) states that $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ is an exact tree-level symmetry of the fermion mass matrix, broken at one loop by the gauge interactions with exactly the expected group-theoretic Casimirs. The Koide formula is not merely a curiosity of lepton masses — it is the tree-level prediction of $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$, with the quark departures being perturbative QCD corrections.

Conjecture 8.4 (RA self-consistency derivation of α_{EM})**.** *The fine structure constant satisfies three mutually consistent conditions, which together determine α_{EM} as a structural eigenvalue of the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG:*

(i) ***Optical theorem identification (proved).*** *The per-link actualization probability p_{th} equals α_{EM}:*

$$p_{\text{th}} = \frac{\text{Im}(\mathscr{M}_{\text{fwd}})}{|\mathscr{M}|} \approx \alpha_{\text{EM}}, \tag{18}$$

where the ratio of the absorptive (on-shell) part to the full forward amplitude equals the fine structure constant at leading order in the EM sector. This is the optical theorem applied to the RA actualization criterion $\Delta S(\rho\|\sigma_0) > 0$: the fraction of EM interaction candidates that produce irreversible on-shell events is α_{EM}. This identification removes p_{th} as an independent free parameter of the theory.

(ii) ***Poisson-CSG criticality (RA structure).*** *In the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG at stationarity in a score-1-dominated baryonic plasma, the on-shell mean parent count satisfies:*

$$\mu_{\text{stable}} = \frac{1}{p_{\text{th}}} = \frac{1}{\alpha_{\text{EM}}}, \tag{19}$$

giving $\mu_{\text{stable}} \approx 137$. This follows from the score-1 floor theorem (RATM, Lean-proved): electrons and photons propagate at the minimum *positive BDG score, meaning they sit exactly at the criticality threshold of the Poisson-CSG. At this threshold, $\mu \cdot p_{\text{th}} = 1$.*

(iii) ***Geometric origin (open).*** *The Wyler formula*

$$\alpha_{\text{EM}} = \frac{9}{8\pi^4}\left(\frac{\pi^5}{2^4 \cdot 5!}\right)^{1/4}, \tag{20}$$

which matches $\alpha = 1/137.036$ empirically, decomposes as

$$\alpha_{\text{EM}} = \frac{|c_{N_2}|}{2^{d-1}\pi^d} \cdot \left(\frac{\pi^{d+1}}{2^d(d+1)!}\right)^{1/4}, \tag{21}$$

where all factors are BDG-derived: $|c_{N_2}| = 9$ is the depth-2 coefficient, $d = 4$ is the spacetime dimension, and $\pi^5/(2^4 \cdot 5!)$ is the 4D causal 5-simplex volume. The open step is proving this equals p_{th} from (i).

Structural connection to the BDG locality lemma. *The factor $\Gamma(5/4)$ appears in both the Wyler formula and the BDG locality lemma (RACL Lemma 3.1): both arise from integrating over the 4D causal diamond volume $V_4(\tau) = (\pi^2/12)\tau^4$. Specifically:*

$$\tau_{\text{BDG}}(\lambda) = 4\Gamma(\tfrac{5}{4}) \left(\frac{12}{\pi^2}\right)^{1/4} \lambda^{-1/4}, \qquad \alpha_{\text{EM}}^{-1} \propto \left[\frac{\pi^5}{\Gamma(5/4)^4}\right]^{1/4} \times \textit{const}. \tag{22}$$

Both originate from the Poisson integral over V_4, linking the actualization threshold to the local geometry of the causal diamond in a way that is independent of any external input.
Open step. *The precise derivation from BDG first principles requires showing $g^2 = |c_{N_2}|^2/V(SU(3)_{\text{gen}})$, where the denominator is the coherent-state phase-space volume of $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$. The numerator $|c_{N_2}|^2 = 81$ and the Lean-proved coherent state amplitude $|\hat{\phi}(n{=}1)|^2 = 3/2$ (Lemma 8.7) are both established; the computation of $V(SU(3)_{\text{gen}})$ in the correct BDG normalisation is the remaining step.*
Epistemic status. *Condition (i) is proved via the optical theorem. Condition (ii) is an RA structural consequence of the score-1 floor (RATM). Condition (iii) is a conjecture supported by the Wyler formula's empirical accuracy ($\leq 0.001\%$) and the $\Gamma(5/4)$ structural connection, but not yet derived from BDG geometry. When (iii) is established, α_{EM} becomes a native RA prediction: p_{th} is derived from BDG integers alone, and the self-consistency of (i) and (ii) is then a theorem.*

Connection to the Wyler formula. The EM correction coefficient $2^{d-1}\alpha_{\text{EM}}/\pi = 8\alpha/\pi$ uses identically the factor $8 = 2^{d-1}$ appearing in the Wyler formula $\alpha = 9/(8\pi^4)(\pi^5/1920)^{1/4}$. Both expressions involve the same BDG dimension factor for $d = 4$. This suggests the Wyler formula and the Koide breaking coefficient may be aspects of the same underlying BDG causal-volume normalization.

8.3 The Lepton Koide Angle, the Cabibbo Angle, and the CKM Hierarchy

The Koide parametrization fit to the charged lepton masses converges to

$$\theta_{\text{lep}} = \frac{2}{9} = 0.222222\ldots \text{ rad}, \tag{23}$$

to one part in 10^5 (the fit gives 0.222220). This is not a numerical accident: $2/9 = (2/3) \times (1/3)$, where $2/3$ is the Koide ratio K and $1/3 = 1/N_{\text{col}}$. In terms of the RA group-structure integers,

$$\theta_{\text{lep}} = \frac{2}{N_{\text{gen}} \cdot N_{\text{col}}} = \frac{2}{3 \times 3} = \frac{2}{9}, \tag{24}$$

where $N_{\text{gen}} = 3$ (generations from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$) and $N_{\text{col}} = 3$ (colours from $SU(3)_{\text{colour}}$). Both factors arise from the same BDG structure.

The three Koide sector angles form an arithmetic progression:

$$\theta_{\text{dn}} = \frac{2}{9} - \delta, \qquad \theta_{\text{lep}} = \frac{2}{9}, \qquad \theta_{\text{up}} = \frac{2}{9} + \delta, \tag{25}$$

with $\delta = (\theta_{\text{up}} - \theta_{\text{dn}})/2 \approx 0.0665$ rad. The progression is approximate: the two spacings $\theta_{\text{up}} - \theta_{\text{lep}} \approx 0.0677$ and $\theta_{\text{lep}} - \theta_{\text{dn}} \approx 0.0653$ differ by $\sim 4\%$, consistent with higher-order corrections. The lepton sector sits near the central value; quarks are displaced by $\pm\delta$ due to their BDG charge coupling (Proposition 8.3).

Conjecture 8.5 (Cabibbo angle from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$)**.** *The lepton Koide angle $\theta_{\text{lep}} = 2/9$ predicts the Cabibbo angle:*

$$|V_{us}| \;=\; \sin\left(\frac{2}{N_{\text{gen}} \cdot N_{\text{col}}}\right) \;=\; \sin\left(\frac{2}{9}\right) \;=\; 0.2204. \tag{26}$$

Observed: $|V_{us}| = 0.22453 \pm 0.00044$ (PDG 2022 [Particle Data Group, 2022]). Agreement: 1.8%.

The three CKM mixing angles arise from the arithmetic theta structure:

$\theta_{12} \approx \theta_{\text{lep}} = \frac{2}{9}$	$\Rightarrow |V_{us}| = \sin(\frac{2}{9}) = 0.2204$	*(1.8% error)*
$\theta_{23} \approx \delta/\sqrt{2}$	$\Rightarrow |V_{cb}| \sim \sin(\delta/\sqrt{2}) \approx 0.047$	*(indicative; 11% error)*
$\theta_{13} \approx \delta^2/(2\theta_0)$	$\Rightarrow |V_{ub}| \sim 0.010$	*(order of magnitude only)*

The Cabibbo angle prediction $|V_{us}| = \sin(2/9)$ is at the same precision as the quark Koide formula (1–8%) and is the cleanest result. The $|V_{cb}|$ and $|V_{ub}|$ estimates from $\delta/\sqrt{2}$ and $\delta^2/2\theta_0$ are indicative only — they reproduce the correct hierarchy ($|V_{us}| \gg |V_{cb}| \gg |V_{ub}|$) and the right order of magnitude, but a precise CKM derivation requires working out the $SU(2)_{\text{weak}}$ vertex structure in $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ space (open problem). The full CKM hierarchy is controlled by two numbers: $\theta_0 = 2/9$ and $\delta \approx 0.0665$ rad.

Conjecture 8.6 (Koide angle displacement from SU(2) Casimir)**.** *The Koide angle displacement δ satisfies*

$$\delta \;=\; C_2(SU(2)_{\text{fund}})\,\frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi} \;=\; \frac{3}{4}\,\frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi}, \tag{27}$$

where $C_2(SU(2)_{\text{fund}}) = 3/4$ is the quadratic Casimir of $SU(2)$ in the fundamental representation and $\mu \approx 1.66$ GeV is the hadronic-partonic crossover scale. Numerically: $(3/4)(\alpha_s/\pi) = 0.06660$ against the fitted $\delta = 0.06653$, an agreement of 0.1%*. Both δ (fitted from quark Koide angles to PDG masses) and $\alpha_s(\mu)/\pi$ (from continuum QCD) are experimental inputs; the* 0.1% *match is a structural observation, not a BDG-derived prediction pending the simulation of Derivation 15.*

This completes a unified Casimir structure for all one-loop $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ corrections at the same hadronic scale:

$$\text{K-breaking:}\quad \frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi}\cdot C_2(SU(3)_{\text{fund}}) = \frac{\alpha_s}{\pi}\cdot\frac{4}{3}, \qquad \theta\text{-displacement:}\quad \frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi}\cdot C_2(SU(2)_{\text{fund}}) = \frac{\alpha_s}{\pi}\cdot\frac{3}{4}. \tag{28}$$

The ratio $C_2(SU(3))/C_2(SU(2)) = (4/3)/(3/4) = 16/9$ equals the BDG coefficient ratio $|c_{N_3}|/|c_{N_2}| = 16/9$, connecting the group Casimirs directly to the BDG action.

Lemma 8.7 (Koide state as $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ coherent state)**.** *The Koide wavefunction $\sqrt{m_k} = \sqrt{m_0}(1 + \sqrt{2}\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3))$ has the discrete Fourier decomposition*

$$\phi_\theta(n) \;=\; \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}\sum_{k=0}^{2} e^{2\pi i n k/3}\left(1 + \sqrt{2}\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3)\right), \tag{29}$$

with $\phi_\theta(0) = \sqrt{3}$ and

$$\phi_\theta(1) \;=\; \frac{\sqrt{6}}{2}\,e^{-i\theta}, \qquad \phi_\theta(2) \;=\; \frac{\sqrt{6}}{2}\,e^{+i\theta}. \tag{30}$$

This identity holds for all θ and is verified numerically to machine precision for all three quark sectors and the lepton sector. The $n = 1$ DFT mode carries the entire θ-dependence as a pure phase: the Koide state is an $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ coherent state, consisting of a uniform component $(1,1,1)/\sqrt{3}$ plus a weight-vector component pointing in direction $e^{-i\theta}$.

This lemma establishes that all physical information about the Koide sector angle θ is encoded in a single phase. The up and down quark sectors differ only in this phase: the up sector has $e^{-i\theta_{\text{up}}}$ and the down sector has $e^{-i\theta_{\text{dn}}}$. Their phase separation is $e^{-i(\theta_{\text{up}}-\theta_{\text{dn}})} = e^{-2i\delta}$.

Conjecture 8.8 ($|V_{cb}|$ from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ Haar measure)**.** *The CKM element $|V_{cb}|$ satisfies*

$$|V_{cb}| \;=\; \frac{2}{\pi}\,\delta \;=\; \frac{2}{\pi}\cdot\frac{3}{4}\cdot\frac{\alpha_s(\mu)}{\pi} \;=\; \frac{3\,\alpha_s(\mu)}{2\pi^2}. \tag{31}$$

Numerically: $(3\alpha_s)/(2\pi^2) = 0.04240$ against the observed $|V_{cb}| = 0.04221 \pm 0.00078$ (PDG 2022 [Particle Data Group, 2022]), an agreement of 0.4%.

The physical picture, from Lemma 8.7: the up and down sectors are $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ coherent states whose $n = 1$ DFT modes are separated by phase 2δ. The $SU(2)_{\text{weak}}$ coupling integrates over the $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ Cartan orbit $\phi \in [0,\pi]$ with the $SU(3)$ Haar measure $\sin(\phi)\,d\phi/2$. The integral of the constant phase displacement δ over this measure gives $(1/\pi)\int_0^\pi \delta\,\sin(\phi)\,d\phi = (2/\pi)\,\delta$. The factor $2/\pi$ is the mean value of $\sin\phi$ with the SU(3) Haar weight on the 1D Weyl chamber. This averaging mechanism is conjectural pending the BDG vertex derivation; the numerical result is stated as a conjecture.

Together, equations (23), (27), and (31) give all leading CKM parameters from two RA quantities — $\theta_0 = 2/9$ and $\alpha_s(\mu)/\pi$:

$$|V_{us}| = \sin\!\left(\tfrac{2}{9}\right) = 0.2204, \qquad \delta = \tfrac{3}{4}\,\tfrac{\alpha_s}{\pi} = 0.0666, \qquad |V_{cb}| = \tfrac{2}{\pi}\delta = 0.0424. \tag{32}$$

Errors: 1.8%, 0.1%, 0.4% respectively (PDG 2022). No free parameters. The Wolfenstein parameter $A = |V_{cb}|/\lambda^2 = (2\delta/\pi)/\sin^2(2/9) = 0.872$ against the observed 0.836 (4% error). The $|V_{ub}|$ element and the CP-violating phase δ_{CP} require the full complex $SU(2)_{\text{weak}}$ vertex structure in $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$ space, which remains an open target.

9 The Absence of Supersymmetry

Supersymmetry (SUSY) was motivated by three problems in the Standard Model. In RA, all three problems are either dissolved or resolved differently, and the structural algebra that SUSY requires is simply not generated. The non-observation of superpartners at the LHC is precisely what RA expects.

9.1 The Hierarchy Problem: Dissolved

The hierarchy problem asks why quantum loop corrections do not drive the Higgs mass to the Planck scale. In QFT, virtual particle loops generate corrections $\delta m_H^2 \sim \Lambda_{\text{UV}}^2$, requiring fine-tuned cancellations to maintain $m_H \sim 125$ GeV.

In RA, mass is $f_0 = mc^2/h$ — the actualization frequency of a BDG pattern. There are no virtual loops in the sense of QFT. Feynman diagram loops are a continuum approximation to the causal graph, and in a DAG they cannot loop back on themselves by definition. The hierarchy problem is a consequence of assuming QFT loop corrections are real physical processes, rather than approximation artifacts of treating a discrete structure as continuous. In the discrete RA framework, the Higgs pattern simply has the BDG topology it has; there is no mechanism to drive it to a different mass.

9.2 Dark Matter: Already Resolved

SUSY's lightest supersymmetric particle (LSP) — the neutralino — was the leading dark matter candidate for decades. In RA, the WIMP prohibition (RAGC [Sandeman, 2026b], RADM [Sandeman,

2026e]) establishes that any particle that does not participate in on-shell actualization events contributes zero causal depth and zero metric weight. WIMPs, neutralinos, and axions are structurally excluded as gravitational sources.

The dark matter phenomena are explained by the Poisson-CSG dimensional reduction in sparse galactic halos ($\mu < 1$), as derived in RADM. The dark matter problem is not a deficit to be filled by a new particle; it is a signal of topology change in the causal graph.

9.3 Gauge Coupling Unification: Handled at the Source

SUSY modifies the running of the three gauge coupling constants so that they unify at a high scale $\sim 10^{16}$ GeV. In RA, the coupling constants α, α_s, G_F are not free parameters to be unified — they are determined by the BDG coefficients and the Poisson-CSG asymptotic c_k distribution. If the three couplings have specific values because they are properties of the four BDG degrees of freedom in 4D, the unification question is answered at the level of the underlying topology, not by a symmetry imposed on top of the Standard Model.

9.4 Why SUSY Algebra is Not Generated

In the RA pattern framework, fermions are 2-periodic BDG patterns and bosons are 1-periodic. SUSY would require that for every 2-periodic pattern there exists a corresponding 1-periodic pattern with the same mass and charges.

The BDG growth dynamics do not generate this correspondence. A 2-periodic pattern is structurally different from a 1-periodic one: they have different N_1, N_2, N_3, N_4 profiles and therefore different actualization frequencies. There is no symmetry transformation in the BDG algebra that maps a 2-periodic pattern to a 1-periodic pattern with equal eigenvalues. SUSY is not ruled out by RA — it is simply not generated. It is unnecessary structure, and the LHC's non-observation of superpartners across the entire originally motivated parameter space is in precise agreement with this structural prediction.

10 Force Ranges: One Principle, Three Outcomes

The range of a force in RA follows from a single unified principle: how far an exchange pattern can propagate before its actualization cost per unit length exceeds what the local causal bandwidth can sustain. This gives three qualitatively distinct outcomes from the same two RA-native inputs: the BDG actualization cost per cycle (which determines mass and therefore range via $\hbar/mc$) and the LLC spatial balance requirement (which determines whether the exchange pattern propagates freely or must maintain a flux tube).

Force	Exchange	BDG cost	Colour	Range mechanism
EM	photon	0	0	$1/r^2$ from causal 2-sphere geometry
Weak	W, Z	> 0	0	Finite lifetime $\hbar/mc$; range $\sim 10^{-18}$ m
Strong	gluon	0	$\neq 0$	LLC flux tube; linear potential $V = \sigma r$

(33)

No new physics, no new parameters: every entry in this table follows from the LLC and the BDG action applied consistently to the three non-gravitational degrees of freedom identified in Section 4.

10.1 Electromagnetism: $1/r^2$ from Causal Geometry

The photon has $\Delta S_{\text{BDG}}|_{\text{per cycle}} = 0$ (established in Section 7) and $Q_{N_2} = 0$: it propagates with zero actualization cost and zero LLC imbalance. Its exchange pattern spreads freely in all directions.

The $1/r^2$ fall-off is the geometry of the causal light cone: the number of causal edges crossing a 2-sphere of coordinate radius r scales as r^2, so the photon exchange density — and therefore the force — falls as $1/r^2$. Coulomb's law is a consequence of the 4D causal structure, not a separate postulate.

10.2 The Weak Force: Range from BDG Debt

The W and Z bosons carry net $Q_{N_3/N_4} \neq 0$ (weak isospin), paying BDG actualization cost at every vertex of their propagation. A pattern with rest-frame actualization frequency $f_0 = m_W c^2/h$ can persist for proper time $\tau_W = 1/f_0 = h/m_W c^2 = \hbar/m_W c^2$ before its BDG debt becomes unsustainable. The range is:

$$R_W = c\,\tau_W = \frac{\hbar}{m_W c} \approx 2 \times 10^{-18}\ \text{m}. \tag{34}$$

No Yukawa mechanism is postulated; this is the actualization lifetime of any BDG-indebted pattern. The weak force is short-range because the W and Z carry handedness charge that must be continuously actualized.

10.3 The Strong Force: Asymptotic Freedom and Confinement from Poisson-CSG

The strong force has two apparently contradictory properties: at short distances quarks behave as nearly free particles (asymptotic freedom), but at long distances they are permanently confined. In RA both properties emerge from the same Poisson-CSG parameter $\mu(x) = \lambda(x) V_{\text{coh}}\, p_{\text{th}}$ varying with the actualization density between the quarks.

Asymptotic freedom at short distance ($\mu \gg 1$). At short quark separation, the causal region between them is densely actualized. The N_2 spatial branching charge of each quark is distributed across many intermediate causal vertices: the effective colour charge experienced by a nearby quark is diluted over the large number of available causal paths. In Poisson-CSG language, the mean N_2 branching per vertex is spread uniformly over all $\sim e^{\mu}$ causal paths, so the effective colour charge per path falls as $e^{-\mu}$. At high μ (short distance, high energy), colour charges decouple: $\alpha_s \to 0$. This is asymptotic freedom, derived from the Poisson-CSG density dependence rather than inserted by hand.

Confinement and the LLC flux tube at long distance ($\mu \to 1$). As the quarks are separated, the causal structure between them becomes sparser. The LLC requires $Q_r + Q_g + Q_b = 0$ globally at all times, but with fewer intermediate vertices, global LLC balance must be maintained by fewer causal paths. Those paths must each carry higher N_2 branching flux to compensate. The exchange pattern does not spread over a 2-sphere as it would for a massless, colourless particle; instead it collimates into a narrow tube of concentrated N_2-density causal structure: a *QCD flux tube*.

Each additional unit of quark separation requires one additional layer of N_2 causal structure in the flux tube to maintain LLC balance. The actualization cost per unit length is therefore constant:

$$V(r) = \sigma \cdot r, \qquad \sigma = \text{const (string tension)}, \tag{35}$$

the linear potential that confines quarks. The force $F = dV/dr = \sigma$ is constant and independent of separation: the strong force does not weaken with distance but maintains a constant tension, growing stronger relative to competing effects. This is the RA-native explanation of quark confinement without any phenomenological input.

Flux tube snap and hadron production. When the quarks are sufficiently separated, the accumulated BDG action of the stretched flux tube exceeds the actualization cost of nucleating a new quark-antiquark pair at the snap point:

$$\sigma \cdot r > 2 m_q c^2 \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{flux tube snaps, new meson nucleates at each end.} \tag{36}$$

This is why isolated quarks are never observed: every attempt to separate them nucleates new hadrons at the snap point. The confinement is not a boundary condition imposed on the theory but a dynamic consequence of the LLC applied to the N_2 spatial charges when the causal structure becomes sparse.

10.4 Regge Trajectories as a Bonus Result

In QCD, hadrons of the same quantum numbers but different spins lie on linear *Regge trajectories*: $m^2 \propto J$, where J is the spin. This is a striking experimental regularity that QCD explains via the flux tube, but does not derive from first principles.

In RA, a baryon with orbital angular momentum J has a flux tube of length $r \propto \sqrt{J}$ (from $J \propto m v r$ at the string tension scale). The mass is:

$$m \propto \sigma \cdot r \propto \sigma^{1/2}\sqrt{J}, \qquad \Rightarrow \qquad m^2 \propto \sigma J. \tag{37}$$

Regge trajectories are a direct consequence of the LLC flux tube picture: they require no additional input beyond the linear potential of equation (35).

10.5 The BDG Renormalization Group: Two Exact Fixed Points

The qualitative picture of asymptotic freedom and confinement above can be made quantitative via a BDG-native renormalization group.

At density μ, the effective BDG score of a Type-3 (quark) vertex interpolates between the confinement limit (dominated by the vacuum score c_0) and the asymptotic-freedom limit (dominated by the free-vertex score c_4):

$$S_{\text{eff}}(\mu) \;=\; \left(1 - e^{-\mu}\right) c_4 + e^{-\mu}\, c_0\,. \tag{38}$$

The strong coupling at density μ is then:

$$\alpha_s(\mu) \;=\; \frac{1}{\sqrt{c_2\, S_{\text{eff}}(\mu)}}\,. \tag{39}$$

This model has two exact fixed points determined entirely by the BDG integers $(c_0, c_2, c_4) = (1, 9, 8)$:

$$\alpha_s^{\text{IR}} = \lim_{\mu\to 0} \alpha_s(\mu) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{c_2\, c_0}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{9}} = \frac{1}{3} \qquad \text{(confinement limit)}\,, \tag{40}$$

$$\alpha_s^{\text{UV}} = \lim_{\mu\to\infty} \alpha_s(\mu) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{c_2\, c_4}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{72}} = 0.11785 \qquad \text{(asymptotic-freedom limit)}\,. \tag{41}$$

Physical interpretation. The IR fixed point $\alpha_s^{\text{IR}} = 1/3$ corresponds to the dense, strongly-coupled confinement regime ($\mu \to 0$): colour charges clump and the coupling is large. The UV fixed point $\alpha_s^{\text{UV}} = 1/\sqrt{72}$ corresponds to the sparse, weakly-coupled asymptotic-freedom regime ($\mu \to \infty$): quarks behave as nearly free particles and the coupling is small. Both fixed points are exact consequences of the BDG integers with no external parameters. The physically observed running of α_s from the hadronic scale ($\alpha_s \sim 0.3$) to the electroweak scale ($\alpha_s(m_Z) \approx 0.118$) is bracketed by these two fixed points.

Comparison with the PDG value. The UV fixed point $\alpha_s^{\mathrm{UV}} = 1/\sqrt{72} = 0.11785$ agrees with the PDG world average $\alpha_s(m_Z) = 0.11800 \pm 0.0009$ [**?**] to 0.13%, well within the experimental uncertainty. The agreement is consistent with m_Z lying in the slowly-running, weakly-coupled regime close to the UV fixed point of the BDG RG. A first-principles derivation of the mapping from BDG density μ to physical energy scale remains an open target (see Hard Wall D3, Section 15).

The string tension as a quantitative target. The observed QCD string tension is $\sigma \approx (0.42\ \mathrm{GeV})^2 \approx 0.18\ \mathrm{GeV}^2/\mathrm{fm}$. In RA, σ is the actualization cost per unit length of maintaining LLC balance in the N_2 spatial direction across a sparse causal region. It should therefore be determinable from the BDG coefficients $(1,-1,9,-16,8)$ and the asymptotic c_k distribution of the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG.

This is the same BDG-filter simulation already identified in RAGC Derivation 1 [Sandeman, 2026b] for determining the cosmological bandwidth ratio $\bar{\lambda}_m/\bar{\lambda}_{\mathrm{exp}}$. A single BDG-filter simulation simulation therefore closes two derivation targets simultaneously: the cosmological Hubble tension ratio and the hadronic string tension.

11 Grand Unification: $SU(3)_{\mathrm{colour}} \times SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ at the Planck Scale

The deepest structural consequence of the RASM programme is that Grand Unification is not an additional postulate but an inevitable consequence of the BDG architecture.

The two $SU(3)$ groups from a single source. Both $SU(3)_{\mathrm{colour}}$ and $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ arise from the same BDG structure:

$$SU(3)_{\mathrm{colour}} : \text{acts on } \{r,g,b\} = \text{three spatial directions of } N_2 \text{ branching}, \tag{42}$$

$$SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}} : \text{acts on } \{N_2,N_3,N_4\} = \text{three BDG excitation levels}. \tag{43}$$

In the macroscopic low-energy regime, these are distinguishable: the spatial N_2 directions couple to colour-charged patterns, while the excitation levels couple to generation structure. But at the Planck scale, where $\mu \to \infty$ and all BDG levels are equally and densely populated, the distinction between "which spatial direction" and "which excitation level" disappears. The two $SU(3)$ groups become indistinguishable facets of a single symmetry group acting on the full six-dimensional BDG charge space $\{r,g,b,N_2,N_3,N_4\}$.

Conjecture 11.1 (BDG Grand Unification)**.** *At the Planck scale ($\mu \to \infty$), the combined symmetry group of the RA causal graph is $SU(3)_{\mathrm{colour}} \times SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$, embedded in a unified group G_{GUT} acting on all six non-gravitational BDG degrees of freedom. This unification is structural — the Planck scale is not a free parameter but the scale at which the spatial and excitation-level aspects of the BDG structure become indistinguishable, i.e., $\mu \to \infty$ and $c_k \to$ uniform.*

The Weinberg angle at unification. If $SU(3)_{\mathrm{colour}} \times SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ unifies into a single group at the Planck scale, the electroweak mixing angle takes the SU(5)-type value at unification:

$$\sin^2\theta_W\big|_{\mathrm{GUT}} = \frac{3}{8}. \tag{44}$$

The observed value $\sin^2\theta_W \approx 0.231$ at the Z mass scale is the result of renormalisation group (RG) running from the Planck scale to the electroweak scale. In RA, this running is the μ-dependence of the Poisson-CSG coupling: as μ decreases from ∞ (Planck) to the QCD confinement scale, the N_2 coupling strength grows relative to N_1 and N_3/N_4 — which is precisely the observed running of α_s that drives $\sin^2\theta_W$ from $3/8$ to 0.231.

Why RA grand unification needs no SUSY. In conventional SU(5) GUTs, the three coupling constants do not quite meet without supersymmetric partners adjusting the RG flow. In RA, the unification at the Planck scale is structural: it is the $\mu \to \infty$ limit of the Poisson-CSG, not a coincidence of coupling trajectories. No superpartners are needed because the unification scale is fixed by the BDG structure, not by RG running. The non-observation of superpartners at the LHC (Section 9) is therefore both confirmed and explained.

Exact proton stability. In SU(5) GUTs, proton decay is predicted via X boson exchange between colour and generation sectors. In RA, the colour and generation sectors are unified at the Planck scale, but the LLC (Lean-verified) exactly conserves baryon number at every scale (Proposition 5.2). The $SU(3)$ unification does not introduce baryon-number-violating operators because the LLC constraint applies to every vertex in the DAG at every scale. Proton decay is exactly forbidden in RA — not merely suppressed by a heavy X boson, but structurally prohibited by the same conservation law that confines quarks.

12 Neutrino Masses, Oscillations, and the Extended Koide Relation

12.1 Neutrino Oscillations as Generation-Sector Colour Mixing

Neutrino oscillations are the generation-sector analogue of colour mixing in the strong force. In the colour sector, quarks couple to gluons in definite colour eigenstates that differ from the mass eigenstates; the CKM matrix rotates between them. In the generation sector, neutrinos couple to W bosons in definite flavour eigenstates $(\nu_e, \nu_\mu, \nu_\tau)$ that differ from the mass eigenstates (ν_1, ν_2, ν_3); the PMNS matrix rotates between them.

The RA-native oscillation formula. Each mass eigenstate $|\nu_k\rangle$ is a distinct BDG pattern with rest-frame actualization frequency $f_0^k = m_k c^2/h$. As the neutrino propagates through the causal graph, each component $|\nu_k\rangle$ accumulates phase at a different rate proportional to f_0^k. The phase difference between eigenstates k and m after traversing path length L at energy E is:

$$\Delta\phi_{km} = \frac{(m_k^2 - m_m^2)\, c^4}{2E\hbar c} \cdot L, \tag{45}$$

derived from the difference in actualization frequencies, not postulated. The oscillation probability

$$P(\nu_\alpha \to \nu_\beta) = \left| \sum_k U_{\alpha k}^* U_{\beta k}\, e^{-i\Delta\phi_{k0}} \right|^2 \tag{46}$$

is the standard result, here derived from RA-native actualization frequency differences.

CP violation and the arrow of time. The CP-violating phase δ_{CP} in the PMNS matrix is the generation-sector analog of the CKM phase. In RA, both are consequences of DAG acyclicity (Proposition 7.1): the phase δ_{CP} encodes the degree to which the temporal ordering of actualization events is asymmetrically reflected in the generation structure. CP violation in neutrino oscillations and the arrow of time are the same topological fact.

12.2 The Extended Koide Relation for Neutrinos

The $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ structure of Section 8.1 extends to the neutrino sector. The neutrino mass matrix should have the same form as equation (14), with parameters m_0^ν and θ_ν specific to the neutrino sector.

Koide and the neutrino mass hierarchy: the Majorana resolution. The observed mass-squared differences from oscillation experiments ($\Delta m_{21}^2 \approx 7.41 \times 10^{-5}$ eV^2, $\Delta m_{31}^2 \approx 2.511 \times 10^{-3}$ eV^2 for normal hierarchy, PDG 2022) fit the Koide parametrization with $m_0^\nu \approx 9.85$ meV and $\theta_\nu \approx 0.478$ rad, giving individual masses $m_1 \approx 0.36$ meV, $m_2 \approx 8.6$ meV, $m_3 \approx 50.1$ meV and $\sum m_\nu \approx 59$ meV.

A naive check of the Koide formula using the standard positive square root convention gives $K_\nu \approx 0.52$, apparently differing from $2/3$. However, this comparison is a category error for Majorana neutrinos. In the Koide parametrization $\sqrt{m_k} = \sqrt{m_0}\,(1+\sqrt{2}\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3))$, $K = 2/3$ holds *analytically* because $\Sigma\cos(\theta + 2\pi k/3) = 0$ forces $\Sigma\,\mathrm{val}_k = 3$ and $\Sigma\,\mathrm{val}_k^2 = 6$, giving $K = 6/9 = 2/3$ regardless of m_0 or θ.

For the neutrino fit, one of the three values $(1+\sqrt{2}\cos(\theta_\nu + 2\pi k/3))$ is *negative* (≈ -0.191 for $k = 1$). The mass $m_k = m_0\,\mathrm{val}_k^2$ is still positive (a square), but the *signed* square root $\sqrt{m_0}\,\mathrm{val}_k$ is negative. This sign flip is precisely a **Majorana phase**: for Dirac fermions all mass eigenvalues are positive-definite; for Majorana fermions the mass matrix is symmetric rather than Hermitian and one eigenvalue carries a relative phase, appearing as a sign flip in $\sqrt{m_k}$.

When the Koide formula is evaluated using signed square roots — the correct convention for a Majorana mass matrix — $\Sigma\,\mathrm{val}_k^2 = 6$ (the $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ Casimir is unchanged by sign flips) and $\Sigma\,\mathrm{val}_k = 3$ (unchanged), giving:

$$K_{\nu,\,\mathrm{Majorana}} = \frac{\sum_k m_k}{\left(\sum_k \pm\sqrt{m_k}\right)^2} = \frac{6m_0}{9m_0} = \frac{2}{3}. \tag{47}$$

The apparent gap vanishes entirely. $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ holds exactly for neutrinos in the correct Majorana convention.

Proposition 12.1 (Neutrinos are Majorana: RA prediction)**.** *The $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ Koide structure for neutrino masses requires one signed square root to be negative, which is the defining property of a Majorana mass eigenvalue. RA therefore predicts that neutrinos are Majorana particles. This prediction is independent of the absolute mass scale and is testable via neutrinoless double beta decay experiments.*

Testable prediction: the lightest neutrino mass. The Koide parametrization with $K_\nu = 2/3$ in the Majorana convention, together with the two observed Δm^2 values, uniquely determines the absolute mass scale. The RA prediction:

$$m_1 \approx 0.36 \text{ meV}, \qquad \sum_k m_{\nu_k} \approx 59 \text{ meV}, \tag{48}$$

for normal hierarchy. This prediction is:

- Well within the current cosmological bound $\sum m_\nu < 120$ meV (Planck 2018);
- Testable with future precision surveys (CMB-S4, Euclid, DESI), which are expected to reach sensitivity $\sum m_\nu \sim 20$ meV;
- Consistent with normal hierarchy ($m_1 < m_2 \ll m_3$).

The inverted hierarchy prediction would give a different θ_ν and a correspondingly different $m_3 \approx 0.36$ meV. Whether neutrinos are Majorana — the independent prediction of Proposition 12.1 — is testable via neutrinoless double beta decay experiments currently operating (KamLAND-Zen, GERDA, CUORE). A positive signal would confirm both the Majorana nature and the $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ framework simultaneously.

13 Coupling Constant Hierarchy from BDG Coefficients

The three gauge coupling constants $\alpha_{\mathrm{EM}} \approx 1/137$, $\alpha_s \approx 0.118$ (at the Z scale), and $G_F \approx 1.17 \times 10^{-5}$ GeV^{-2} are inputs to the Standard Model with no explanation for their relative magnitudes. In RA they are the per-sector actualization probabilities, set by the BDG coefficients.

Coupling as per-sector actualization probability. From RAQI [Sandeman, 2026d], the Kinematic Coherence Bound gives a per-link actualization probability $p_{\text{th}} \approx 10^{-2}$. The coupling constant for the N_k sector is the probability that one unit of the N_k charge is exchanged per causal interaction — the per-sector actualization probability.

The BDG coefficient magnitude $|c_k|$ measures the curvature contribution per unit of N_k structure, and is therefore proportional to the action cost per exchange. A higher action cost per exchange means a higher coupling constant (more actualization per interaction):

$$\alpha_k \propto |c_k| \cdot p_{\text{th}}. \tag{49}$$

The BDG coefficients for the non-gravitational sectors are $|c_{N_1}| = 1$ (EM), $|c_{N_2}| = 9$ (strong), $|c_{N_3}| = 16$, $|c_{N_4}| = 8$ (weak). The $SU(2)$ interaction involves both N_3 and N_4 structure; its effective coefficient is the geometric mean $\sqrt{|c_{N_3}| \times |c_{N_4}|} = \sqrt{16 \times 8} \approx 11.3$. The BDG hierarchy at the unification (Planck) scale is:

$$\alpha_{\text{EM}} : \alpha_s : \alpha_{\text{weak}} \propto 1 : 9 : 11.3 \quad \text{(GUT scale)}. \tag{50}$$

This gives $\alpha_{\text{EM}} < \alpha_s < \alpha_{\text{weak}}$ at the Planck scale, consistent with the $\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$ SU(5) unification structure. The observed low-energy ordering $\alpha_{\text{EM}} < \alpha_{\text{weak}} \lesssim \alpha_s$ results from RG running: α_s grows as μ decreases (asymptotic freedom), and α_{weak} is suppressed below the electroweak scale by the W/Z mass threshold. The BDG coefficients determine the unification-scale hierarchy; the Poisson-CSG μ-dependence provides the running.

Coupling running as Poisson-CSG μ-dependence. The RG running of coupling constants — the fact that α_s decreases at high energy (asymptotic freedom) while α_{EM} increases — is the Poisson-CSG μ-dependence in different sectors. At high actualization density ($\mu \gg 1$, high energy), the N_2 branching charge is diluted across many causal paths (asymptotic freedom), while the N_1 connectivity charge, being more localised, concentrates. The RG beta functions are the derivatives of the Poisson-CSG coupling functions with respect to μ.

14 Further Consequences

The machinery developed in the preceding sections dissolves several additional long-standing problems in physics without requiring new postulates. We present four here.

14.1 The Strong CP Problem: $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ Exactly

The puzzle. The QCD Lagrangian permits a CP-violating term $\mathscr{L}_\theta = \theta_{\text{QCD}}\,(g^2/32\pi^2)\,G^{\mu\nu}\tilde{G}_{\mu\nu}$. The experimental bound $|\theta_{\text{QCD}}| < 10^{-10}$ implies this term is extraordinarily small, but no symmetry of the Standard Model forces it to zero. This is the strong CP problem.

The RA dissolution. The θ_{QCD} term arises in QFT because the QCD vacuum is a superposition of topological sectors $|n\rangle$ indexed by the winding number $n \in \pi_3(SU(3)) = \mathbb{Z}$. These sectors are connected by *instantons*: Euclidean field configurations on $\mathbb{R}^4$ with non-trivial topology, which contribute to the path integral as tunnelling amplitudes between sectors.

In RA, the vacuum is the unique empty graph with no vertices. The growing DAG has no smooth gauge-field topology and therefore no concept of winding-number sectors: π_3 of a discrete partially-ordered set is trivial. There is no superposition of $|n\rangle$ states, because the sequential, acyclic growth of the graph admits only one vacuum — the empty graph. Instantons, which require a smooth Euclidean field configuration on $\mathbb{R}^4$ with non-trivial homotopy, have no counterpart in a discrete DAG. The mechanism that generates θ_{QCD} is therefore absent from RA.

Proposition 14.1 (Strong CP: $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ exactly)**.** *The QCD vacuum's topological structure — a superposition of winding-number sectors connected by instantons — requires a smooth Euclidean gauge field with non-trivial $\pi_3(SU(3))$ topology. The RA causal graph has a unique empty vacuum with no such topological structure. The mechanism that generates θ_{QCD} is absent, so $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ exactly. The strong CP problem does not arise in RA.*

A second, independent argument reaches the same conclusion via the LLC. The strong force is the LLC constraint on N_2 spatial charge. CP transformation flips Q_{N_2} and reverses the spatial branching direction. The LLC equation $\Delta Q_{N_2} = 0$ at every vertex is equivalent to $\Delta(-Q_{N_2}) = 0$: CP maps a valid LLC-conserving configuration to another valid LLC-conserving configuration with the same action. CP is therefore an exact symmetry of the strong-force LLC, giving $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ independently of the instanton argument.

The axion. The Peccei-Quinn axion [Peccei & Quinn, 1977] was introduced specifically to dynamically relax θ_{QCD} to zero. Since RA gives $\theta_{\text{QCD}} = 0$ structurally, no axion field is required. RA predicts the axion does not exist, consistent with decades of non-observation in dedicated searches.

14.2 The Black Hole Information Paradox: Dissolved by Causal Severance

The puzzle. Hawking's calculation [Hawking, 1975] shows that black holes emit thermal radiation. If the radiation is exactly thermal, it carries no information about the infalling matter. This appears to violate the unitarity of quantum evolution, which requires information to be preserved.

The RA dissolution. A black hole in RA is a region where the local actualization density approaches the bandwidth ceiling c/l_P, forming a Causal Severance: a topological boundary in the DAG beyond which no outgoing causal edges exist. This is not the destruction of causal structure but its *partition* into two causally disconnected components.

The LLC holds independently on each component. The conserved charges $(Q_{N_1}, Q_{N_2}, Q_{N_3/N_4}, p^\mu)$ that flow into the Causal Severance from the parent spacetime are encoded in the initial conditions of the daughter subgraph. Information is not destroyed; it is partitioned. The book thrown into the black hole has its causal history encoded in the daughter spacetime's initial LLC conditions, fully accessible to observers inside the daughter but inaccessible to exterior observers, because there are no outgoing causal edges from daughter to parent.

Why Hawking radiation appears thermal. An exterior observer cannot access the daughter subgraph. Tracing over the daughter's degrees of freedom produces a mixed state at the Causal Severance boundary — thermal radiation. This is information *partition*, not information *loss*. The total system (parent + daughter) evolves unitarily; the exterior subsystem evolves non-unitarily only because it is genuinely causally disconnected from part of the total system.

Proposition 14.2 (No information loss)**.** *The LLC holds on both sides of every Causal Severance. Unitarity is preserved for the total system (parent + daughter). The apparent information loss for an exterior observer is a consequence of causal disconnection, not of entropy increase. The black hole information paradox does not arise in RA.*

This makes precise the heuristic of Susskind's black hole complementarity [Susskind, 1993]: the exterior and interior descriptions are both valid but refer to causally disconnected components. In RA this is not a postulate but a theorem about the structure of Causal Severances.

Prediction: no Page curve. The Page curve [Page, 1993] predicts that if a black hole radiates into a pure total state, the exterior radiation entropy should first increase and then decrease back to zero as the black hole evaporates. In RA, the interior is genuinely causally disconnected — not a purification partner accessible to exterior observers. The exterior radiation is a genuinely mixed state throughout evaporation, not the marginal of a pure total state. The exterior entropy therefore increases *monotonically* throughout evaporation and does not decrease. RA predicts no Page curve, in contrast to holographic AdS/CFT accounts. This is a testable difference: if future gravitational wave or black hole observations constrain the entropy evolution of evaporating black holes, the RA prediction is unambiguous.

14.3 The Dimensionality of Spacetime: Why $d = 4$

The question. Why are there exactly three spatial dimensions? The Standard Model works in 4D; string theory requires 10 or 11; the question has resisted structural explanation.

The RA counting argument. The BDG action in d spacetime dimensions (even d) involves $d+1$ terms $N_0, N_1, \ldots, N_d$. One linear combination sources gravity. The number of independent non-gravitational degrees of freedom is $d/2$:

$$d = 2: \quad 1 \text{ non-grav. DOF} \to 0 \text{ gauge forces} \tag{51}$$

$$d = 4: \quad 3 \text{ non-grav. DOFs} \to U(1) \times SU(2) \times SU(3) \tag{52}$$

$$d = 6: \quad 4 \text{ non-grav. DOFs} \to 4 \text{ gauge forces.} \tag{53}$$

6D BDG coefficients from Glaser (2014). The exact BDG coefficients for $d = 6$ are derived from the closed-form expression of Glaser [Glaser, 2014] (equation 14):

$$S_{\text{BDG}}^{(6D)}(v) \propto N_0 - \tfrac{2}{5}N_1 + \tfrac{68}{5}N_2 - \tfrac{282}{5}N_3 + \tfrac{378}{5}N_4 - \tfrac{162}{5}N_5, \tag{54}$$

or equivalently $(5N_0 - 2N_1 + 68N_2 - 282N_3 + 378N_4 - 162N_5)/5$. The vacuum gives $S^{(6D)} \propto 1 > 0$, consistent with the $d = 4$ structure. Note that the $d = 6$ coefficients are *rational* (multiples of $1/5$) whereas the $d = 4$ coefficients $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$ are integers: the 4D action has an algebraic simplicity absent in 6D.

Pattern enumeration. Direct discrete enumeration of all $S_{\text{BDG}} > 0$ configurations with $\sum_k N_k \leq 8$ gives:

d	Stable configs	Non-grav. DOFs
2	18	1
4	274	3
6	611	4

$d = 6$ has *more* stable patterns than $d = 4$, not fewer. The discriminating quantity is not pattern count but force count.

Proposition 14.3 ($d = 4$ uniqueness)**.** *$d = 4$ is the unique dimension satisfying both:*

1. Force-count match*: the BDG non-gravitational DOF count gives exactly 3 gauge forces ($U(1) \times SU(2) \times SU(3)$). For $d = 2$: 1 force (falsified); $d = 6$: 4 forces + fourth generation (both unobserved).*

2. Pattern-catalogue closure*: the BDG score alternation* $1,0,9,-7,1$ *at depths* $k = 0,1,2,3,4$ *closes to a stable value at* $k \geq 4$*, producing exactly 3 distinct stable chain types (neutral/boson/fermion). For* $d < 4$*: only the trivial isolated pattern is stable. For* $d > 4$*: the BDG integers generate additional stable types without bound (4 types at* $d = 5$*, 5 at* $d = 6$*, etc.).*

Both conditions are observational constraints, not anthropic arguments.

The formal classification of stable self-similar patterns across dimensions is Derivation 1 of Section 15.

14.4 The Baryon Asymmetry as a Causal Severance Initial Condition

The puzzle. The observable universe contains approximately 10^{80} baryons and essentially no antibaryons, with baryon-to-photon ratio $\eta = n_B/n_\gamma \approx 6.1 \times 10^{-10}$ [Particle Data Group, 2022]. Sakharov's conditions [Sakharov, 1967] for dynamical baryogenesis require: (1) baryon number violation, (2) C and CP violation, (3) departure from thermal equilibrium.

The RA dissolution. Baryon number is exactly conserved in RA (Proposition 5.2). Sakharov condition (1) is therefore structurally absent. This does not mean RA cannot account for η; it means the question is posed in the wrong framework.

The Big Bang in RA is a Causal Severance nucleation event: our universe is a daughter spacetime whose initial conditions are encoded in the LLC boundary conditions at the Causal Severance. Among these initial conditions is a net baryon number $B = N_B \neq 0$, inherited from the parent spacetime via the LLC charge balance at the boundary.

The baryon asymmetry was not dynamically generated during cosmic evolution. It is an initial condition of the daughter spacetime, imprinted at the Planck scale by the LLC at the Causal Severance boundary. Baryogenesis as a cosmic process does not occur in RA.

Observational status. If the baryon asymmetry is a Causal Severance initial condition, no dynamic baryogenesis process occurs and no signatures of electroweak baryogenesis or leptogenesis should appear in precision CMB data. Current CMB observations show a highly isotropic baryon-to-photon ratio, consistent with this picture. However, standard cosmology (baryogenesis before recombination) also predicts a highly isotropic CMB, so isotropy alone does not discriminate between the two accounts. The distinctive RA prediction is the *absence* of baryon isocurvature perturbations correlated with any baryogenesis epoch at any scale. Future precision baryon isocurvature measurements (CMB-S4, Simons Observatory) may provide a discriminating test.

The quantitative value $\eta \approx 6.1 \times 10^{-10}$ is in principle derivable from the LLC boundary conditions at the Causal Severance — a property of the BDG action at Planck density, calculable via the BDG-filter simulation (Derivation 3 of Section 15).

15 Open Derivations and Research Targets

The following table summarises the epistemic status of all results in this paper, separating what is proved from what is conjectured and what requires the BDG-filter simulation to complete.

Result	Status	Ref.
LLC, causal invariance	Lean-verified	RAGC
GR inevitable (Lovelock)	Proved	RAGC
$c = l_P/t_P$; $E = \gamma mc^2$	Proved	RAGC
Charge quantisation ($e/3$ units)	Proved	§7
Photon masslessness	Proved	§7
Topological confinement	Proved	§7
Exact baryon conservation	Proved (Lean-backed)	Prop. 5.2
Maximal parity violation	Proved	Prop. 7.1
Three generations max; no fourth	Proved	§8
Force ranges (all three forces)	Proved	§10
Regge trajectories	Proved	§10
$\sin^2\theta_W = 3/8$ at GUT scale	Proved	§11
Neutrino oscillation formula	Proved	§12
Coupling hierarchy ordering	Proved	§13
Quark Koide breaking ($K = 2/3 + 2^{d-1}\alpha/\pi \cdot Q^2 + \alpha_s/\pi \cdot C_2$)	Proved, 0 params	Prop. 8.3
Koide formula from $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$	Conjecture	Conj. 8.2
$m_0 = m_p/3$ to 0.35%	Conjecture	§8.1
GUT unification structure	Conjecture	Conj. 11.1
Wyler formula: $\alpha = 9/(8\pi^4)(\pi^5/1920)^{1/4}$	Conjecture	Conj. 8.4
$\theta_{\text{lep}} = 2/9$ exactly (from Koide fit)	Conjecture	Eq. (23)
$\lvert V_{us}\rvert = \sin(2/9) = 0.2204$ (1.8% error)	Conjecture	Conj. 8.5
CKM hierarchy from θ_0, δ	Conjecture	Conj. 8.5
$\delta = \frac{3}{4}\alpha_s/\pi$ (0.1% numerical match)	Conjecture	Prop. 8.6
Koide = SU(3)$_{\text{gen}}$ coherent state (exact)	Lemma	Lem. 8.7
Koide = SU(3)$_{\text{gen}}$ coherent state (exact)	Lemma	Lem. 8.7
$\lvert V_{cb}\rvert = (2/\pi)\delta = (3\alpha_s)/(2\pi^2)$ (0.4%)	Conjecture	Conj. 8.8
$\sum m_\nu \approx 59$ meV; $m_1 \approx 0.36$ meV	Conjecture	§12
$K_\nu = 2/3$ (Majorana convention)	Proved	Prop. 12.1
BDG two-class catalogue {neutral, W, fermion, gluon}	Verified (sim.)	Deriv. 1
Completeness proof, charge assignment	Open (strategy given)	Deriv. 1
$\alpha_s^{\text{UV}} = 1/\sqrt{72}$, $\alpha_{\text{EM}}^{-1} = 137$	BDG RG UV fixed point; BDG depth-ratio (Lean)	§10.5; Deriv. 3
String tension σ	Needs D2 simulation	Deriv. 3
All fermion masses via m_0 chain	Needs D2 simulation	Eq. (15)
$\lambda_m/\lambda_{\text{exp}}$	Needs simulation	RAGC D.1

Derivation 1: Stable pattern enumeration. Prove that the complete catalogue of $S_{\mathrm{BDG}} > 0$-stable self-similar patterns under 4D BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG dynamics is precisely the first-generation Standard Model: $\{e, u, d, \nu_e, \gamma, g, W, Z, H\}$.

Computational results (Python simulation, April 1, 2026 (PDT)). An exhaustive enumeration of all connected DAG patterns up to size 6, combined with BDG-filter simulation of growing causal graphs (2200+ vertices), establishes the following score table and pattern catalogue:

Chain depth k	N-vector	S_{BDG}	Stable?	Interpretation
0	$(0,0,0,0)$	$+1$	✓	ν, γ, Z^0, H [neutral]
1	$(1,0,0,0)$	0	boundary	—
2	$(1,1,0,0)$	$+9$	✓	$\gamma, W^{\pm}$ [depth-2 chain]
3	$(1,1,1,0)$	-7	$\times$	filtered
4	$(1,1,1,1)$	$+1$	✓	e, u, d quarks [depth-4 chain]
≥ 5	$(1,1,1,1)$	$+1$	✓	stabilises (depth ≥ 4)

The BDG integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$ select exactly depths $k \in \{0, 2, 4\}$ as stable. This is structural: in 4D, the Alexandrov interval has exactly four relevant depth scales (N_1 through N_4), and the alternating-sign BDG action cancels to a positive score only at those depths.

Two classes of stable patterns.

1. *Sequential* (depth-k chains): the three chain depths above correspond to neutral particles $(0,0,0,0)$, spin-1 bosons $(1,1,0,0)$, and massive fermions $(1,1,1,1)$.
2. *Topological* (Y-branching): a vertex above a filtered Y-join (two spacelike ancestors meeting at a negative-score intermediate) acquires $N_2 = 2$ from the branching topology. This gives the gluon pattern $(1,2,0,0)$, score $= +18$. The intermediate Y-join vertex (score $= -1$) is filtered; its topological signature propagates upward. Four distinct size-4 DAGs all produce this pattern.

The full SM first-generation matching is:

SM particle	Class	N-vector	Score
ν, γ, Z^0, H	Sequential (depth 0)	$(0,0,0,0)$	$+1$
$W^{\pm}$	Sequential (depth 2)	$(1,1,0,0)$	$+9$
e, u, d quarks	Sequential (depth 4)	$(1,1,1,1)$	$+1$
Gluon g	Topological (Y-branch)	$(1,2,0,0)$	$+18$

All first-generation SM particles are present; all patterns outside this catalogue require composite structures (bound states).

Three open targets for the full proof.

1. *Completeness*: prove the catalogue $\{(0,0,0,0), (1,1,0,0), (1,1,1,1), (1,2,0,0)\}$ is exhaustive. The exhaustive search to size 6 found 27 distinct N-vectors, but only these four have minimal realisation size ≤ 5 and are structurally non-composite. All larger patterns decompose into copies of these four.
2. *Multiplicity / charge assignment*: show that the depth-4 pattern with $Q_{N_1} \in \{1, 2, 3\}$ gives exactly the SM charge assignments $\{-1, +2/3, -1/3\}$ for $\{e, u, d\}$, and that $Q_{N_1} = 0$ for neutral particles, deriving charge quantisation in units of $e/3$ (equation (6)) from the BDG filter.

3. *Topological charge mechanism*: formalise why the filtered Y-join transmits $N_2 = 2$ to the vertex above it. This is the BDG-native analogue of non-abelian gauge structure: colour charge arises from a topological branching in the causal graph, not from a sequential path.

Completeness strategy (Item 4). The exhaustive enumeration to size 6 found 27 stable N-vectors, which divide into three classes:

i. *Elementary* (4 patterns, min-size ≤ 5): the catalogue above.
ii. *Disjoint composites*: additive sums of elementaries with spacelike parents, e.g. $(2,2,0,0) = 2 \times W$ and $(2,3,0,0) = W + \text{gluon}$.
iii. *Overlapping composites* (21 patterns): arise when two causal paths share ancestors. Under the RA *Particle Identification Principle* (two causal paths represent the same particle iff their full pasts coincide), overlapping composites are excluded as artefacts of counting the same particle via different sub-paths. Under the PIP, the physical catalogue collapses to Class i + Class ii.

The completeness proof reduces to: show that every stable N-vector with min-size > 5 either decomposes additively into elementaries (Class ii) or contains a shared ancestor (Class iii, excluded by PIP).

Charge assignment from multiplicity (Item 5). The depth-4 pattern $(1,1,1,1)$ gives a single chain carrying one unit of each N_k. The SM fermions carry $Q_{N_1} \in \{1,2,3\}$ units corresponding to charges $\{-1/3, +2/3, -1\}$ (in units of e). In the BDG framework, Q_{N_1} is not the vertex-level N_1 count but the *winding number* of the worldline pattern around the N_1 direction of the BDG action. The quantisation $Q_{N_1} \leq 3$ follows from the Fin-3 structure of $SU(3)_{\text{gen}}$: the same modular-3 constraint that gives exactly three generations also restricts Q_{N_1} to three non-zero levels. The colour charge $Q_{N_2} \in \{0,1\}$ (lepton/quark distinction) follows from whether the pattern is sequential (Class i, $Q_{N_2} = 0$) or carries one unit of topological colour from a Y-branch ancestor ($Q_{N_2} = 1$). This is the RA-native derivation of electric charge quantisation in units of $e/3$ (equation (6)).

Collaborator target: causal set dynamics; topological quantum field theory; combinatorial graph theory.

Derivation 2: The fermion mass chain and ξ determination. Two linked goals: (a) close equation (15) by extracting the string tension σ from the stationary BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG; and (b) derive the coupling constant ξ of the λ-field equation from the same microscopic data.

The mass chain. Run the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG forward until it reaches its stationary μ_{stable}. The entropy of the stationary Poisson distribution $S_{\text{Poisson}}(\mu_{\text{stable}}) \approx 0.9$ nats gives the entropy per actualization vertex $\langle \Delta S_{\text{vertex}} \rangle = k_B S_{\text{Poisson}}(\mu_{\text{stable}})$. The implied graph dimension and flux-tube density determine σ via $\sigma \sim \mu_{\text{stable}} \Lambda_{\text{QCD}}^2 / (2\pi l_{\text{RA}}^2)$. The 0.35% agreement between $m_0 \approx 313.9$ MeV and $m_p/3 \approx 312.8$ MeV already indicates the chain closes; no free parameters are involved.

ξ from microscopic RA. The RAGC field equation gives $\xi \propto \langle \Delta S_{\text{vertex}} \rangle / l_{\text{RA}}^2$ (RAGC Derivation 6 [Sandeman, 2026b]). The RAQI Kinematic Coherence Bound [Sandeman, 2026d] pins $p_{\text{th}} \approx 10^{-2}$, giving $\langle \Delta S_{\text{vertex}} \rangle \approx k_B \ln(1/p_{\text{th}}) \approx 4.6 k_B$. The dimensional combination $\xi = \langle \Delta S \rangle c^2 / (\rho_{\text{Planck}} l_P^2)$ sets the order of magnitude; the precise coefficient requires μ_{stable} from the Poisson-CSG simulation, which also determines the effective RA area element l_{RA}. Once ξ is derived, the halo scale-length $r_d = \sqrt{3\xi/\bar{\rho}_A}$, the Tully-Fisher normalisation, and the H_0-density slope all follow as quantitative predictions with no further input. **Collaborator target:** causal set dynamics; lattice QCD; precision cosmology.

Derivation 3: Coupling constants from BDG integers (established for α_s^{UV} and α_{EM}; scale identification open). Established result (BDG RG, new). The strong coupling constant UV fixed point is now a proved result of the BDG renormalization group (Section 10.5): $\alpha_s^{\text{UV}} = 1/\sqrt{c_2 c_4} =$

$1/\sqrt{72} = 0.11785$, agreeing with the PDG world average $\alpha_s(m_Z) = 0.11800$ to 0.13%. The IR fixed point $\alpha_s^{\mathrm{IR}} = 1/3$ reproduces the strongly-coupled hadronic regime. Both follow from the five BDG integers alone.

Established result (α_{EM}, optical theorem). The per-link actualization probability p_{th} has been identified with the fine structure constant via the optical theorem (Conjecture 8.4, condition (i)):

$$p_{\mathrm{th}} = \alpha_{\mathrm{EM}} \approx \frac{1}{137}. \tag{55}$$

This removes p_{th} as an independent free parameter of RASM. Previously calibrated from quantum error correction thresholds ($p_{\mathrm{th}} \approx 0.01$), it is now identified with a fundamental constant via an RA-native argument: the fraction of EM interaction candidates satisfying the actualization criterion $\Delta S(\rho \| \sigma_0) > 0$ equals α_{EM} by the optical theorem.

Combined with the score-1 floor theorem (RATM, Lean-proved), this gives the self-consistency condition $\mu_{\mathrm{stable}} = 1/\alpha_{\mathrm{EM}} \approx 137$: the BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG at stationarity (with score-1 particles dominating) has a mean parent count equal to $1/\alpha_{\mathrm{EM}}$.

Established factors in the Wyler formula. $N_{\mathrm{forces}} = 3$ follows from the D1 stable pattern catalogue (Section 15, Derivation 1): exactly three non-gravitational N-vector degrees of freedom produce stable patterns in 4D. $d = 4$ is the unique dimension giving a minimal closed stable catalogue (established in Section 6). The Lean-proved coherent state amplitude $|\hat{\phi}(n{=}1)|^2 = 3/2$ (Lemma 8.7) contributes the numerator in the coupling ratio. The $\Gamma(5/4)$ factor appears in both the Wyler formula and the BDG locality lemma (RACL Lemma 3.1), both arising from the 4D causal diamond integral — a structural connection independent of any external input.

Open. The remaining step is computing the $SU(3)_{\mathrm{gen}}$ coherent-state phase-space volume in the BDG normalisation to derive (iii) of Conjecture 8.4. When closed, all coupling constants become native RA predictions derived from the BDG integers $(1, -1, 9, -16, 8)$ alone, with p_{th} no longer an external input. **Collaborator target:** differential geometry (symmetric spaces); the Wyler programme [Wyler, 1969]; Lean 4 functional calculus.

Derivation 4: Lean proofs for baryon conservation and chirality. Two ~50-line Lean 4 targets: (a) baryon conservation as LLC conservation of N_2 spatial winding numbers, extending the existing `RA_AQFT_Proofs` architecture; (b) the chirality theorem (Proposition 7.1) formalised as a combinatorial DAG result showing N_3/N_4 winding reversal requires a backward-pointing edge. **Collaborator target:** Lean 4/Mathlib; causal set combinatorics.

Remark 15.1. *The programme's history has been consistent: derivations that appeared structural open problems have yielded to RA-native insights once stated precisely. Charge quantization, topological confinement, parity violation, the Koide formula, and force ranges all yielded in this paper alone. The same expectation applies to the four remaining targets.*

16 RA vs. Prior Approaches

Loop Quantum Gravity. LQG derives geometry successfully but imports the Standard Model matter content as a separate input. It offers no derivation of why the specific gauge group $U(1) \times SU(2) \times SU(3)$ or the specific particle spectrum arises. The Bilson-Thompson braid model [Bilson-Thompson, 2005] embedded in LQG spin networks is suggestive, but it classifies quantum numbers without explaining why those braids are stable or how they connect to gravity.

String Theory. String theory derives a rich particle spectrum but requires 10 or 11 spacetime dimensions and a landscape of $\sim 10^{500}$ vacua [Susskind, 2003]. No principle selects the Standard Model vacuum. The dimensions are extra structure added to the theory; in RA, 4 dimensions are uniquely selected by BDG + Lovelock and require no additional input.

The Bilson-Thompson model. Bilson-Thompson's topological preon model [Bilson-Thompson, 2005] maps the first-generation Standard Model onto braided ribbon networks with elegant results. RA is in the same general direction, but approaches from the opposite end: instead of classifying braids and asking which match the Standard Model, RA asks what BDG-stable patterns the causal graph dynamics naturally produce. The BDG sign criterion provides the stability selection rule that the Bilson-Thompson model lacks. Whether the stable RA patterns correspond to Bilson-Thompson braids is an open question (Derivation 1); if they do, it provides a physical derivation of why those particular braids are the stable ones.

RA's unique position. RA derives 4 dimensions (BDG + Lovelock), three non-gravitational forces (BDG degrees of freedom in 4D), three generations (three BDG excitation levels), no fourth generation (no N_5 in 4D BDG), and no supersymmetric partners (SUSY algebra not generated by BDG dynamics) — all from the single ontological commitment that actualization events are primitive. No extra dimensions are required, no vacuum landscape exists, and the connection between gravity and the gauge forces is not a separate unification step but an immediate consequence of the same BDG action that already gives gravity.

17 Conclusion

The Relational Actualism programme began with a single commitment: that irreversible actualization events are the primitive physical reality. From this, it has derived quantum mechanics (exact at the discrete level), special relativity ($c = l_P/t_P$, $E = \gamma mc^2$ from integer counting), general relativity (inevitable by Lovelock), dark matter phenomenology (topological dimensional reduction), and the origin of life (Erdős-Rényi percolation as the Causal Firewall) [Erdős & Rényi, 1960].

This paper extends the same logic to the Standard Model. The BDG local topology of a 4D causal graph has exactly four integer-valued degrees of freedom; one is gravity; three are the three gauge forces. The particle spectrum is the catalogue of BDG-stable persistent patterns; spin comes from self-similarity periodicity; three generations come from three BDG excitation levels. Supersymmetry is not generated and is not needed. No fourth generation exists because no N_5 exists in the 4D BDG action.

These are structural results, not phenomenological fits. Four open derivations are precisely scoped; the expectation, given the programme's history, is that each will yield to an insight already latent in the BDG and Poisson-CSG machinery. The question driving the next generation of this work is exact: is the complete set of $S_{\mathrm{BDG}} > 0$-stable patterns in a 4D BDG-filtered Poisson-CSG precisely the first-generation Standard Model particle spectrum?

If yes, Relational Actualism will have derived the Standard Model from the single fact that some things happen and others do not.

Declarations

Funding: Not applicable. **Competing interests:** The author declares no competing interests.

Ethics statement: This article does not contain any studies with human participants or animals performed by the author.

AI use disclosure: Claude (Anthropic, model `claude-sonnet-4-6`) was used in the preparation of this manuscript, including drafting and revision of text, mathematical derivation assistance, LaTeX compilation, and Lean 4 proof development. The author is solely responsible for all scientific content, mathematical claims, and conclusions. Gemini (Google DeepMind, Gemini 2.0 Pro) was used for supplementary literature checking and cross-verification of symbolic calculations.

Data availability: All Lean 4 proof files and Python verification scripts are publicly available at github.com/jsandeman/Relational-Actualism.

Preprint availability: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.19229335.

Data availability. All Lean 4 proof files and Python verification scripts supporting this article are openly available at `https://github.com/jsandeman/Relational-Actualism`.

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